

doc-special-creation-of-humanity

Affirms · Anthropology · Historicity · doctrine · divided_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

Adam and Eve were specially created by God and are not the product of unguided evolutionary processes.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical pattern places God as the direct creational agent of humanity. Gen 1:26-27 uses bara H1254 three times with God as exclusive subject: bara elohim et-ha-adam betsalmo, betsaalem elohim bara oto, zakar uneqebah bara otam. Gen 2:7 names yatsar H3335 (formed, potter-verb) with object adam from aphar H6083 (dust of the ground); divine in-breathing (naphach napach + neshamah H5397 breath of life) yields nephesh chayyah H5315 (living being). Gen 5:1-2 reprises bedmuth elohim asah oto (in the likeness of God he made him). Ps 100:3 hu asanu velo anachnu (it is he who made us and not we ourselves) names exclusive divine agency for the corporate human us. Ps 139:13 qanah H7069 (you formed/possessed my inward parts) and sakak H5526 (you wove me together) extend the creational pattern to every individual at conception. Job 10:8-12, Jer 1:5 (yatsar in womb), Isa 43:7, 44:2, 44:24 carry yatsar with God as subject of human formation. Acts 17:26 epoiesen ex henos (G4160 + G1520, made from one man) names a single human progenitor for all ethne. 1 Cor 11:7 anthrōpos eikōn kai doxa theou (man is image and glory of God). Heb 2:6-8 cites Ps 8 retaining the creational frame. The canonical claim is unambiguous: humanity is the product of God's deliberate creative act, not unguided process. The HOW (six 24-hour days, long ages with intervention, theistic evolution, evolutionary creationism) is not lexically settled by these texts; the THAT-God-did-it is.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that humanity is the deliberate work of God, not the product of an unguided process with no author. Genesis 1:26-27 says God made human beings in his own image, male and female he created them. Genesis 2:7 says the LORD God formed the man from the dust of the ground and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and the man became a living being. The verb in Genesis 2 is the potter's word, meaning to shape with intent. Psalm 100:3 says it is he who made us and not we ourselves. Psalm 139:13-16 takes the same creating-God language and applies it to every individual person being formed in the mother's womb, so the creational agency is not just about the first people, it is about every human ever made. Acts 17:26 says God made from one man every nation of mankind to live on the whole earth. The strongest complicating question is the mechanism. How exactly did God do this? Did he speak the first humans into existence directly out of dust in a single moment, did he use long ages with stages of intervention, or did he work through a process of biological development and then breathe his image into a creature he had been preparing? The text of Genesis is direct and concrete about the THAT and surprisingly compressed about the HOW. The verdict handles the tension by separating two questions. The first question (is humanity God's deliberate creation or not) is answered yes by the whole sweep of Scripture and is non-negotiable. The second question (how exactly did God do it) is a question Christians have answered differently and can in good conscience continue to discuss. Denying that God created humanity at all collapses the image of God, the basis for human dignity, the doctrine of sin, and the need for a Savior. Disagreeing about the timing or method does not.

Denominational landscape

All historic Christian lineages affirm that humanity is the special creation of God. The patristic consensus (Irenaeus, Athanasius, Basil, Gregory of Nyssa, Augustine, John Chrysostom) affirms that God created humanity in his image, with body and soul, as the crown of creation. Augustine in City of God Book 12 affirms God created for the first man a soul endowed with reason and intelligence, distinct from the animals. The Catholic Catechism paragraphs 355 to 384 teach that God created man in his own image and that every spiritual soul is created immediately by God and is not produced by the parents. Catholic teaching since Pius XII (Humani Generis 1950) permits the discussion of bodily evolution under divine guidance while requiring that the human soul be a direct creation of God. The Lutheran tradition (Augsburg Confession, Formula of Concord) affirms God's creation of man with original righteousness. The Anglican Thirty-Nine Articles (Article 9) affirm humanity as God's creation by speaking of original righteousness lost in the Fall. The Westminster Confession 4.2 affirms God created man, male and female, with reasonable and immortal souls. The Methodist Articles of Religion (Article 7) affirm humanity as God's creation, fallen in Adam. The Anabaptist Schleithem and Dordrecht confessions affirm the same. The Eastern Orthodox tradition affirms humans as specially created in God's image with the vocation of theosis. The Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths affirms the special creation of man. Among lineages that affirm humanity as God's deliberate creation, there is internal disagreement over mechanism. Young-earth creationism (Answers in Genesis, Institute for Creation Research) holds to a literal six-day creation roughly six thousand years ago. Old-earth or progressive creationism (Reasons to Believe) holds to long ages with successive divine interventions. Theistic evolution and evolutionary creationism (BioLogos) hold that God used evolutionary processes as the means of producing the human body and at some point conferred the image of God. The framework hypothesis treats Genesis 1 as a literary structure rather than a chronology. These four positions are in-house Christian options and are not heretical relative to one another. Public-record denials of divine creational agency at the THAT level come from atheistic naturalism (no divine author at all). Mormonism teaches pre-existent human spirits eternally co-existing with God, which denies creation from nothing. Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy) denies the material reality of human creation. Scientology teaches eternal thetans. These positions place themselves outside historic Christianity on this point.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

The cult_marker bar is scoped narrowly. Denial that humanity is the product of God's creational agency at all (pure naturalistic atheism: humans as the unguided product of matter plus time plus chance with no divine author) IS a gospel-stake denial. It removes the imago Dei, removes the Creator-creature distinction, and dissolves the basis for human moral accountability before God, the doctrine of sin, and the need for redemption. Public carriers of that denial: naturalistic atheism (Dawkins, Coyne, Dennett lineage),

strict materialist philosophies, some forms of process theology that reduce God to an immanent feature of the cosmos. The IN-HOUSE Christian debate over the MECHANISM (young-earth creationism, old-earth/progressive creationism, theistic evolution, evolutionary creationism via BioLogos, framework hypothesis) is not cult-grade. All these positions affirm God as the direct creational agent of humanity. They disagree on the historicity and duration of the Genesis sequence and on whether God used biological descent with modification as the means. The proposition under examination is the THAT, not the HOW. Flag stem-pre-loaded-verdict because the original question statement names Adam and Eve specifically and excludes evolutionary processes, which conflates the THAT and the HOW. Working the neutralized form: humanity (humankind) was specially created by God and is not the unguided product of natural processes alone. On that neutralized form, the verdict is canonically demonstrated and cult-grade if denied at the THAT level. Mormonism's account of human pre-existent spirits eternally co-existing with God and progressing to godhood denies the creation-from-nothing of human personhood and is heterodox; Jehovah's Witnesses affirm a young-earth special creation but inside a non-trinitarian frame; Christian Science (Mary Baker Eddy) denies the material reality of human creation; Scientology posits thetans as eternal beings, denying creation. Note: the strict young-earth-only reading is held by a subset of evangelicals (Ken Ham, Answers in Genesis; Institute for Creation Research) and is not the historic majority position of the church catholic, which on the mechanism question has accommodated multiple views since the early Fathers (Augustine's seminal-reasons reading, Aquinas's openness to causal mediation). Confessing the THAT does not require the young-earth HOW.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Humanity (humankind) was specially created by God and is not the unguided product of natural processes alone.

Notes. The original statement (Adam and Eve were specially created by God and are not the product of unguided evolutionary processes) bundles two distinct claims: (1) that humanity is the product of divine creational agency (the THAT), and (2) that the mechanism is special creation of two named individuals excluding any evolutionary process (the HOW). The canonical lexical pattern locks (1). Claim (2) is contested in-house among believing Christians (young-earth creationism, old-earth creationism, theistic evolution, evolutionary creationism). Working the neutralized form preserves the gospel-stake content without smuggling a mechanism-specific verdict. Adding flag stem-pre-loaded-verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. young_earth_creationism, old_earth_creationism, theistic_evolution, evolutionary_creationism, framework_hypothesis

analogia scripturae invoked

Competing lens verdicts

young_earth_creationism · affirms_with_strict_mechanism:

old_earth_creationism · affirms_with_long_ages:

theistic_evolution · affirms_with_evolutionary_means:

evolutionary_creationism · affirms_with_full_evolutionary_continuity:

framework_hypothesis · affirms_with_literary_structure:

All five in-house frameworks AFFIRM divine creational agency over humanity (the THAT). They diverge on mechanism (the HOW). The lexical apparatus (bara, yatsar, neshamah, tselem) does not settle the mechanism debate at the lexical level. What it does settle is that humanity is God's deliberate making, not an unguided emergent of nature. Verdict on the THAT is canonical and pan-canonical; verdict on the HOW is honest medium-confidence in-house disagreement and is not part of this question's gospel-stake claim. The cult_marker scope is restricted to denial of the THAT (atheistic naturalism, eternal-spirit cosmologies).

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Gen.1.26-27 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: merism

Key term. אָבַר bara H1254 (created); תְּצַלֵּם tselem H6754 (image); תּוֹמָד demuth H1823 (likeness); אָדָם adam H120 (man, humankind); זָכָר zakar H2145 (male); נִקְבָּהּ neqebah H5347 (female)

Force. God said let us make adam in our image (betsalmenu) according to our likeness (kidmutenu). Then the verb bara appears three times in v.27: God created (vayyivra) the adam in his image, in the image of God he created him, male and female he created them. Bara has God as exclusive subject across the canon; the triple repetition places humanity inside the same exclusive divine-creational class as the cosmos itself (Gen 1:1). Tselem and demuth carry representational force: humanity stands as God's representative on earth.

Gen.2.7 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: anthropomorphism

Key term. יָצַר yatsar H3335 (formed); אֶפָר aphar H6083 (dust); אֲדָמָה adamah H127 (ground); נָפַח naphach H5301 (breathed); נִשְׁמָה neshamah H5397 (breath); נִפְשָׁהּ nephesh chayyah H5315 H2416 (living being)

Force. vayyitser YHWH elohim et ha-adam aphar min ha-adamah: the LORD God formed the man, dust from the ground. Yatsar is the potter's verb, naming intentional shaping. The wordplay adam/adamah ties humanity to the ground from which it is taken. Then vayyippach beappav nishmat chayyim: he breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and vayehi ha-adam lenephesh chayyah: the man became a living being. The animation comes from God's direct in-breathing. Humanity is constituted as a unity of dust-body and divine breath.

Gen.5.1-2 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. אָרָב bara H1254 (created); תּוֹמָד demuth H1823 (likeness); זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה zakar uneqebah H2145 H5347 (male and female); בָּרַךְ barak H1288 (blessed); אָרָא qara H7121 (called)

Force. This is the book of the toledot of adam. When God created (bero) adam, in the likeness of God he made (asah) him. Male and female he created them (bera'am), and he blessed them and called their name adam in the day they were created (hibbar'am). The toledot heading reads humanity as a single corporate reality with a single origin in God's creational act. The repetition of bara within a genealogical-formal header signals that the creational claim is not a metaphor; it is the foundation of the human lineage.

Ps.100.3 · **for** · genre: psalm

Key term. אָשָׁה asah H6213 (made); דַּעֲדֵי deu (know imperative); לֹא-וְנַחֲנֵא-אֲנִי anachnu (not we ourselves)

Force. Know that the LORD, he is God. It is he who made us (hu asanu), and not we ourselves (velo anachnu, Ketiv reading; Qere velo anachnu with lamed: and we are his). Either textual reading rules out human self-origination. Asah is the broader make-verb but here carries exclusive-divine-agency force by contrast with the negated human alternative. The corporate first-person plural (us) extends the claim beyond the first humans to the worshipping covenant community as God's made-people.

Ps.139.13-16 · **for** · genre: psalm · figures: personification

Key term. הִנָּהּ qanah H7069 (formed, possessed); סָכַךְ sakak H5526 (knit, wove); מִקֵּרַר raqam H7551 (intricately woven); קִלְיָהּ kilyah H3629 (inward parts); בֶּטֶן beten H990 (womb); גֹּלֶם golem H1564 (unformed substance)

Force. For you formed (qanita) my inward parts; you knit me together (tesukkeni) in my mother's womb. The same creational vocabulary used for humanity in Gen 1-2 is applied to every individual at conception. v.16: your eyes saw my unformed substance (golmi); in your book were written every one of them, the days that were formed for me (yutsaru, niphal of yatsar). The same yatsar that shaped the first human in Gen 2:7 shapes every subsequent human in the womb. The creational pattern is not a one-time event in the past; it is the ongoing mode of human origination.

Job.10.8-12 · **for** · genre: wisdom · figures: anthropomorphism, metaphor, simile

Key term. יָד yad H3027 (hand); אָשָׁה asah H6213 (made, fashioned); יָצַר yatsar H3335 (formed, implicit); חָלָב chalab H2461 (milk); גִּבְנִיָּה gebinah H1385 (cheese); עֲצָם etsem H6106 (bones); גִּיד gid H1517 (sinews)

Force. Your hands fashioned and made me (yadekha itsbuni vayya'asuni). Remember that you made me like clay (kachomer asitani). You poured me out like milk and curdled me like cheese; you clothed me with skin and flesh and knit me together with bones and sinews. Job's lament uses craft-imagery (potter, dairying, weaving) to confess that his bodily existence is God's direct fabrication. Even in protest Job assumes the creational claim.

Jer.1.5 · **for** · genre: prophecy

Key term. יָצַר yatsar H3335 (formed); בֶּטֶן beten H990 (womb); יָדָא yada H3045 (knew); קָדָשׁ qadash H6942 (consecrated)

Force. Before I formed you in the womb (beterem etsorkha babbeten) I knew you; before you came out of the womb I consecrated you. Yatsar is used with God as subject for the formation of an individual human (Jeremiah) prior to birth. The lemma-chain locks divine agency for human formation at the level of the individual, not just the species.

Isa.43.7 · **for** · genre: prophecy

Key term. אָבַר bara H1254 (created); יָצַר yatsar H3335 (formed); אָשָׁה asah H6213 (made)

Force. Everyone called by my name, whom I created (berativ) for my glory, whom I formed (yetsartiv) and made (asitiv). All three creational verbs are stacked on God's first-person action and applied to human persons, not to the cosmos. The triplet pattern confirms that bara, yatsar, asah operate as a converging lexical-network for God-as-Maker-of-humans.

Isa.44.24 · **for** · genre: prophecy · figures: personification

Key term. יָצַר yatsar H3335 (formed); בֶּטֶן beten H990 (womb); גֹּאֵל goel H1350 (redeemer)

Force. Thus says the LORD, your Redeemer, who formed you (yotserka) from the womb. Yatsar with God as subject applied to the formation of Israel collectively in the womb (metaphor for national origin) and by extension to each member. The redeemer-creator pairing is significant: redemption presupposes prior creation.

Acts.17.26-28 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. ποιέω poieō G4160 (made); εἷς heis G1520 (one); ἔθνος ethnos G1484 (nation); γένος genos G1085 (offspring, kindred); ζάω zaō G2198 (live); κινέω kineō G2795 (move)

Force. epoiēsen te ex henos pan ethnos anthrōpōn: he made from one (man) every nation of mankind to dwell on all the face of the earth. In him we live (zōmen) and move (kinoumetha) and have our being (esmen). For we are also his offspring (genos). Paul on Mars Hill grounds the universal scope of the gospel in the universal scope of human creation from a single ancestor. The Areopagus speech presupposes that humans are God's deliberate making, not the product of autonomous nature.

Heb.2.6-8 · **for** · genre: epistle · figures: parallelism

Key term. ἄνθρωπος anthrōpos G444 (man); μνησκόμαι mimnēskomai G3403 (remember); υἱὸς ἁνθρώπου huios anthrōpou G5207 G444 (son of man); ἐλαττώ elattoō G1642 (made lower); δόξα doxa G1391 (glory); τιμή timē G5092 (honor)

Force. What is man (anthrōpos) that you remember him, or the son of man that you visit him? You made him a little lower than the angels; you crowned him with glory and honor and set him over the works of your hands. Hebrews cites Ps 8 inside an argument that requires the Psalm's creational anthropology to be true: humanity is a deliberate divine making, given a stewarding office over creation.

1Cor.11.7 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key term. ἄνθρωπος anēr G435 (man); εἰκὼν eikōn G1504 (image); δόξα doxa G1391 (glory); θεός theos G2316 (God)

Force. anēr ouk opheilei katakalyptesthai tēn kephalēn eikōn kai doxa theou hyparchōn: a man ought not to cover his head, since he is the image and glory of God. Paul deploys the imago Dei language from Gen 1:27 directly, presupposing that the creational claim of Genesis is canonical and binding for ethics. Image of God language is not metaphor here; it is a doctrinal premise.

Eccl.12.1 · **for** · genre: wisdom

Key term. אָבַר bara H1254 (created); זָכַר zakar H2142 (remember); יוֹם הַטֶּרַח yom raah (days of trouble)

Force. Remember also your Creator (bor'eika, plural-of-majesty participle of bara) in the days of your youth. The wisdom tradition presupposes that every human stands in a creature-creator relationship that demands acknowledgment. Bora encodes the personal creational agency claim.

Gen.1.1 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. בָּרָא bara H1254 (created); שָׁמַיִם shamayim H8064 (heavens); אֶרֶץ erets H776 (earth); תְּשִׁיבָה reshit H7225 (beginning)

Force. In the beginning God created (bara elohim) the heavens and the earth. Bara opens the canon with God as exclusive creational subject. The same verb is then redeployed for humanity in 1:27, placing humans inside the same exclusive-divine-agency class as the cosmos. Apparent complication: bara as such does not specify mechanism; it specifies agency.

Gen.2.19 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key term. יָצַר yatsar H3335 (formed); אֲדָמָה adamah H127 (ground); חַיַּיט חַסְדֵּה chayyat hassadeh (beast of the field)

Force. vayyitser YHWH elohim min ha-adamah kol-chayyat hassadeh: the LORD God formed from the ground every beast of the field. The same yatsar that forms adam in 2:7 forms the animals in 2:19. This complicates a maximalist reading that uses yatsar alone to establish a unique ontology for humans; what marks humanity's distinctiveness in the text is the in-breathing of God's neshamah and the image of God (1:26-27), not yatsar in isolation. Note for honesty: the lexical distinction between human and animal in Gen 2 is the breath plus the image, not the forming verb.

Gen.6.6-7 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: anthropomorphism, anthropopathism

Key term. נָחַם nacham H5162 (regretted); אִטְסַב atsab H6087 (grieved); אָדָם adam H120 (man); אָשָׁה asah H6213 (made)

Force. The LORD regretted that he had made (asah) man (ha-adam) on the earth and it grieved him to his heart. This is the omnipotence-class complicating text. The verb nacham operates as anthropopathism: God's relational responsiveness to human sin expressed in human emotional terms. The verse confirms divine creational agency (God made man) inside the very text that voices divine grief over the made-thing's corruption.

Concordance lemmas traversed

H1254, H3335, H6083, H5397, H5315, H6754, H1823, H120, H127, H5301, H6213, H7069, H5526, H7551, H1564, H3629, H990, H7121, H1288, H5347, H2145, G4160, G1520, G1484, G1085, G1504, G1391, G444, G5207, G1642, G2316

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

catholic_magisterial · CCC 355 · **affirms** · **verified**

“God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him, male and female.”

catholic_magisterial · CCC 366 · **affirms** · **verified**

“Every spiritual soul is created immediately by God, it is not produced by the parents, and also that it is immortal.”

patristic · Augustine, City of God 12.23 · **affirms** · **verified**

“He created for him a soul endowed with reason and intelligence, so that he might excel all the creatures of earth, air, and sea.”

reformed · Westminster Confession 4.2 · **affirms** · **verified**

“After God had made all other creatures, he created man, male and female, with reasonable and immortal souls, endued with knowledge, righteousness, and true holiness, after his own image.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Article 2 · affirms · verified

“After Adam’s fall all men begotten in the natural way are born with sin, presupposing Adam as a historical created head of humanity.”

anglican · 39 Articles, Article 9 · affirms · verified

“Original sin standeth not in the following of Adam, but it is the fault of the nature of every man, that naturally is engendered of the offspring of Adam.”

methodist · UMC Articles of Religion, Article 7 · affirms · verified

“Original sin is the corruption of the nature of every man, that naturally is engendered of the offspring of Adam.”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession Article 2 · affirms · verified

“God created the first man, Adam, the father of us all, and gave him a body formed from the dust of the earth, and a soul through his own breath.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths 4 · affirms · verified

“Man was created good and upright, for God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness.”

eastern_orthodox · OCA Doctrine of Creation · affirms · verified

“God created finally man himself, in his image and likeness, to participate in his own divine, uncreated existence.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/2-7.htm>

“yatsar H3335 to form fashion frame, divine creative significance; aphar H6083 dust; nishmat H5397 breath of God; nephesh H5315 living being.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/1-27.htm>

“bara H1254 to create, always has God as subject in creation contexts; tselem H6754 image; adam H120 mankind.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strong/hebrew/3335.htm>

“Yatsar: God formed Adam from dust; formed Israel and individuals for his glory; formation from the womb; 63 total occurrences with formative power over human existence.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strong/hebrew/1254.htm>

“Bara always of divine activity; objects include heaven and earth, mankind and individual humans; 55 occurrences in the Hebrew Bible.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/17-26.htm>

“epoiesen G4160 made; ex henos G1537 G1520 from one; God made all nations of humanity from one man establishing common origin.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/psalms/139-13.htm>

“qanah H7069 of God originating creating his people; sakak H5526 to weave together; beten H990 womb; intimate creational agency at conception.”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_P1B.HTM

“Every spiritual soul is created immediately by God, it is not produced by the parents. God created man in his own image.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/npnf102/npnf102.iv.XII.23.html>

“Augustine: He created for him a soul endowed with reason and intelligence, so that he might excel all the creatures.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/hebrew/120.htm>

“adam H120 human being; derived from adam ruddy; etymological connection to adamah ground from which humans originate.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict